

Phinma University of Iloilo

College of Information Technology Education

In partial fulfillment of the requirements in Capstone 2 subject

Pusong mandirigma

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Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

2025-26

Chapter I

Abstract

Pusong Mandirigma is a historical-fantasy narrative that explores the themes of courage, leadership, and self-discovery. The story follows Jeshra, a modern-day student who initially mocks her classmate and questions the relevance of history during a lesson on the Battle of Mactan. Through a mysterious encounter with a glowing Lapu-Lapu figurine, she is transported back to 1521, experiencing firsthand the daily lives, struggles, and valor of the villagers preparing to defend their land. Witnessing Lapu-Lapu's unwavering commitment to his people and the chaos of the historic battle against Magellan, Jeshra gains a profound understanding of responsibility, bravery, and the true meaning of leadership. Returning to the present, she realizes that history is not just a record of the past—it is a mirror that teaches lessons on courage, integrity, and the value of standing up for what is right.

Chapter I

Introduction

History is often seen as a subject confined to textbooks and classrooms, a series of names, dates, and battles that many students memorize without truly understanding. But history is more than that—it is a reflection of human courage, sacrifice, and the choices that shape the future. Pusong Mandirigma follows Jeshra, a modern-day student who views history as boring and irrelevant. She mocks her classmates and questions the purpose of learning about events that happened centuries ago, failing to see how the past connects to the present.

Her perspective changes when a mysterious, glowing Lapu-Lapu figurine transports her back to the year 1521, placing her in the midst of the Mactan village. There, Jeshra experiences the everyday life of the villagers, the preparation for an impending battle, and the steadfast leadership of Lapu-Lapu. She witnesses firsthand the courage, unity, and sense of responsibility that defined the people of that time—lessons that no book could fully convey.

Through the chaos of the Battle of Mactan, the confrontation with Magellan, and the villagers' determination to defend their land, Jeshra begins to understand that leadership is not measured by power or authority, but by one's willingness to protect and serve others. Returning to her own time, she realizes that history is not a distant story—it is a guide, a mirror that teaches values of courage, integrity, and accountability.

Pusong Mandirigma is a story about awakening to the lessons of the past, discovering the importance of responsibility, and understanding that true strength lies in action, heart, and principle.

Problem Statement

Many students today view history as irrelevant, boring, or disconnected from their everyday lives. They often memorize events, dates, and figures without understanding the lessons behind them or their significance in shaping character and values. This detachment can lead to a lack of appreciation for the principles of courage, leadership, and responsibility exemplified by historical figures like Lapu-Lapu.

In Pusong Mandirigma, this problem is embodied by Jeshra, a modern-day student who mocks both her classmates and the purpose of learning history. Her lack of understanding reflects a larger issue: the difficulty of engaging students in meaningful ways that connect historical events to personal growth and moral development. The story explores how experiencing history, rather than simply

reading about it, can transform perspectives, instill values, and help learners realize the practical relevance of past events in shaping their present and future actions.

Objective

The objective of the Pusong Mandirigma capstone project is to create a compelling and immersive animated short film that leverages the fusion of Philippine history and imaginative storytelling to explore the themes of courage, leadership, and personal responsibility. The specific objectives include:

Cultural Re-imagining:

Bring Philippine history and culture to life by blending the historical events of the Battle of Mactan with a modern-day perspective, showcasing the team's ability to make ancestral narratives engaging and relevant for contemporary audiences.

Storytelling Innovation:

Develop a captivating, character-driven narrative following Jeshra's transformation from skepticism and mockery to understanding and growth, exploring themes of courage, leadership, and personal responsibility while making historical events relatable to modern viewers.

Emotional and Psychological Impact:

Evoke a range of emotions, from Jeshra's initial boredom and frustration to awe, respect, and empathy, by immersing audiences in the lives of Lapu-Lapu, his warriors, and the villagers, highlighting the universal struggle to stand up for what is right and defend one's values.

Visual and Immersive Excellence:

Create a visually striking animated experience with detailed character expressions, dynamic action sequences, and atmospheric lighting, transporting viewers seamlessly between the present-day classroom and the historical setting of Mactan.

Narrative Significance:

Deliver a meaningful resolution that emphasizes the importance of leadership, integrity, and accountability, leaving the audience with a lasting understanding of how history shapes personal growth and moral perspective.

Industry Relevance:

Position Pusong Mandirigma as a benchmark for culturally rooted animated storytelling, demonstrating the potential of Philippine history to inspire visually and emotionally compelling narratives that resonate with both local and global audiences.

Scope and Limitation of the Study

The scope of the Pusong Mandirigma capstone project focuses on creating an animated short film that blends historical events with imaginative storytelling to highlight the themes of courage, leadership, and personal responsibility. The story primarily centers on the experiences of Jeshra, a modern-day student, as she is transported to the historical setting of the Battle of Mactan, witnessing the lives, struggles, and heroism of Lapu-Lapu, his warriors, and the villagers. The project emphasizes the cultural and historical significance of Philippine history, presenting it in a visually engaging and emotionally compelling manner that is accessible to both local and global audiences.

The animation combines dynamic character-driven narratives, atmospheric environments, and historical action sequences to create an immersive experience.

However, the study has limitations. The narrative is a fictionalized adaptation of historical events, meaning some elements are dramatized for storytelling and animation purposes rather than strict historical accuracy. The scope is limited to selected events surrounding the Battle of Mactan and does not encompass the entire historical period or other related historical figures. Additionally, the project's focus on a short film format limits the depth and detail that can be portrayed within the story, and technical constraints in animation, such as time, resources, and software capabilities, may affect the level of detail and complexity achievable in visual effects and character animation.

Significance of the Study

The Pusong Mandirigma capstone project is significant because it bridges the gap between history and contemporary learning by presenting Philippine historical events in an engaging and immersive animated format. For students and viewers, the project demonstrates that history is not merely a collection of dates and events, but a source of valuable lessons on courage, leadership, and personal responsibility.

For educators, the animation serves as a tool to enhance the teaching of history, making it more relatable and inspiring critical thinking about the relevance of past events in modern life. For the creative and animation community, the project highlights the potential of Philippine history and culture as rich sources of compelling storytelling, showcasing innovative approaches in animation, visual design, and narrative development.

Ultimately, the study emphasizes the importance of understanding and reflecting on historical events, inspiring audiences to connect past lessons to personal growth, ethical decision-making, and the development of values that transcend time.

Chapter II

Related Literature

The study *Pusong Mandirigma* draws inspiration from a combination of historical texts, animation theory, and narrative frameworks that provide a foundation for understanding the convergence of Philippine history, cultural storytelling, and animated filmmaking. A guiding text for this research is *The Literature Review: Six Steps to Success* by Lawrence A. Machi and Brenda T. McEvoy (ISBN: 978-1452240886). This work emphasizes that a literature review must synthesize existing knowledge to demonstrate a researcher's expertise and provide a clear rationale for the study's creative direction, rather than simply listing sources.

The structural approach of this project is informed by *Proposal Writing for Clinical Nursing Capstones and Clinical Projects* by Wanda E. Bonnel and Katharine Vogel Smith (ISBN: 978-0826122896). Though originating from a different discipline, this text underscores the universal importance of a literature review in identifying gaps in established knowledge. For *Pusong Mandirigma*, this involves identifying the gap between traditional classroom history instruction and immersive storytelling that makes historical events emotionally and morally relevant to modern audiences.

Exploration of Existing Techniques and Narrative Theory in Animation

For animation techniques, the study references *The Animator's Survival Kit* by Richard Williams (ISBN: 978-0571202287). Williams' exploration of principles such as "weight," "timing," "spacing," "overlapping action," and "squash and stretch" provides the technical foundation for animating both realistic and dynamic action sequences in *Pusong Mandirigma*, including battle movements, environmental interactions, and character expressions. Applying these principles ensures that historical events, such as the Battle of Mactan, feel grounded and believable while maintaining visual engagement.

To support the narrative and character-driven elements, Joseph Campbell's *The Hero with a Thousand Faces* (ISBN: 978-1577315933) serves as a framework for Jeshra's journey. Campbell's concepts of the "threshold struggle" and "hero's transformation" provide guidance for portraying Jeshra's development from skepticism to understanding, illustrating her moral growth and the universal lessons of leadership, courage, and responsibility.

For cultural and historical authenticity, the project draws upon scholarly works on Philippine history, such as *Barangay: Sixteenth-Century Philippine Culture and Society* by William Henry Scott (ISBN: 978-9711004707). Scott's research informs the depiction of daily life, social structures, and cultural practices in Mactan, ensuring that the animation balances historical accuracy with narrative engagement.

Finally, in terms of visual storytelling, the study references *Creating Characters with Personality* by Tom Bancroft (ISBN: 978-0823021972), which emphasizes designing characters that communicate personality, emotion, and intention clearly through movement, expression, and visual design. This guides the portrayal of Lapu-Lapu, Jeshra, and the villagers, making their courage, determination, and leadership visually legible to audiences.

These sources collectively support the creative and technical foundation of *Pusong Mandirigma*, ensuring that the project is not only a visually engaging animated short but also a culturally and historically grounded narrative that resonates with viewers on multiple levels.

1. The Foundation of Literature Reviews

1. Philippine Historical Context

Scott, W. H. (1994). *Barangay: Sixteenth-Century Philippine Culture and Society*. Ateneo de Manila University Press.

ISBN- 13: 978- 9711004707

→ A foundational academic reference on Filipino society and culture around the time of the Battle of Mactan. Directly supports historical authenticity.

Agoncillo, T. A. (1990). *History of the Filipino People*. Garotech Publishing.

ISBN- 13: 978- 9712302009

→ Provides broader context on Spanish arrival, Filipino resistance, and leadership figures.

2. Narrative & Story Structure for Character Transformation

Campbell, J. (2008). *The Hero with a Thousand Faces*. New World Library.

ISBN- 13: 978- 1577315933

→ Supports your portrayal of personal transformation and meaningful journey.

Vogler, C. (2007). *The Writer's Journey: Mythic Structure for Storytellers & Screenwriters*. Michael Wiese Productions.

ISBN- 13: 978- 1932907362

→ Applies Campbell's ideas specifically to narrative writing, useful for your script.

3. Animation Technique & Visual Storytelling

Williams, R. (2001). *The Animator's Survival Kit*. Faber & Faber.

ISBN- 13: 978- 0571202287

→ Fundamental guide for professional animation technique.

Thomas, F., & Johnston, O. (1995). *The Illusion of Life: Disney Animation*. Disney Editions.

ISBN- 13: 978- 1562829415

→ Classic resource on expressive animated movement and character emotion.

4. Educational Engagement Through Storytelling

Hein, G. E. (1998). *Learning in the Museum*. Routledge.

ISBN- 13: 978- 0415918331

→ Not about animation per se, but supports story as a learning tool — useful if your project aims to teach history via animation.

5. Methodology & Academic Writing

Machi, L. A., & McEvoy, B. T. (2016). *The Literature Review: Six Steps to Success*. Corwin Press.

ISBN- 13: 978- 1506336244

→ Helps structure why and how you conducted the literature review.

Chapter III

To begin, this chapter provides an overview of the research objectives and their alignment with the goals of the Pusong Mandirigma capstone project. This section establishes a clear connection between the research aims and the broader focus of the project, highlighting the relevance of the

study in both creative and educational contexts. By doing so, the methodology ensures that the research efforts directly contribute to producing a culturally grounded, visually compelling, and pedagogically meaningful animated short film.

Research Description

Pusong Mandirigma is an animated short film that reimagines Philippine history, focusing on the Battle of Mactan and the life of Lapu-Lapu, as experienced through the perspective of a modern-day student, Jeshra. The study explores themes of leadership, courage, personal responsibility, and the relevance of historical lessons in contemporary life. By combining narrative development, historical research, and animation production, the project aims to create an immersive learning experience that connects audiences emotionally and intellectually with Philippine history.

Research Methodology

This study employs a mixed-methods approach, integrating qualitative research with creative production-based analysis to achieve a holistic understanding of the narrative, historical accuracy, and technical requirements of the animation.

Qualitative Research:

Qualitative data is gathered through content analysis of historical texts on the Battle of Mactan, the social and cultural structures of 16th-century Philippine society, and scholarly interpretations of Lapu-Lapu's leadership. Expert consultations with historians and cultural scholars provide insights into cultural authenticity, social dynamics, and ethical representation. This approach ensures that the narrative accurately reflects historical events while delivering meaningful lessons about leadership, courage, and responsibility.

Production-Based Research:

Technical data is collected through iterative prototyping of animation sequences, focusing on character movement, battle choreography, environmental interactions, and expressive storytelling. This includes visual experimentation with lighting, motion dynamics, and perspective to convey action, tension, and emotional depth. Production-based research ensures that the animation meets professional standards while effectively engaging viewers.

Data Analysis:

Collected data undergoes rigorous thematic and technical analysis. Historical and cultural content is coded for recurring motifs, social values, and leadership lessons. Animation prototypes are evaluated for visual coherence, motion believability, and narrative impact. Integration of these analyses ensures that the final product balances historical fidelity, educational value, and cinematic engagement.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical considerations are central to this study. Cultural and historical accuracy is prioritized, and sensitive portrayal of historical figures and indigenous practices is maintained. Care is taken to avoid misrepresentation or perpetuation of stereotypes, ensuring that the animation respects Philippine heritage while delivering an engaging narrative.

Conclusion

The mixed-methods research design of Pusong Mandirigma aligns with the project's objectives, combining historical research, narrative analysis, and technical animation production. This approach enables a nuanced exploration of Philippine history and its lessons, while ensuring the animated short film is both visually compelling and educationally meaningful. By grounding creative decisions in research, the project demonstrates how history can be made accessible, relevant, and inspiring for modern audiences.